

**“I DEMAND OF YOU, AND THE
WHOLE WORLD, THAT YOU SHOW
ME A GENERIC CHARACTER—
ONE THAT IS ACCORDING TO
GENERALLY ACCEPTED PRINCIPLES
OF CLASSIFICATION, BY WHICH
TO DISTINGUISH BETWEEN
MAN AND APE. I MYSELF MOST
ASSUREDLY KNOW OF NONE ...”**

Carl Linnaeus

In a letter written to J. G. Gmelin, 1747

◀ **In *Systema Naturae* (1735)**, Linnaeus classified plants based on the number and arrangement of stamens in a plant's flower.